



white cane

I CAN.

Walk with us for
independence.

OCT 17, 2026 • DALLAS
ZOO • WHITECANEDAYWALK.COM

MESSAGING TOOLKIT

THE PLATFORM

White Cane. I Can.

The creative platform for the White Cane Day Walk — and the foundation we build on every year.

THE IDEA

Hidden inside the words **white cane** is the phrase I CAN. That wordplay is our signature device and our emotional through-line: vision loss can take independence away suddenly—and with the right support, it's rebuilt. Every reason to walk becomes an "I can."

WHY IT LASTS

This isn't a one-year theme. The stories change; the truth doesn't. New faces, new spots, new years — the same platform underneath. It's built to be reused, refreshed, and recognized, so the walk feels like itself every single year.

THE CONSTANTS

- The device — the **i** in white, the **can** in cane.
- The tagline — "Walk with us for independence."
- The voice — person-first, always: people who are blind or have low vision.
- The lead — Envision and the mission, first.
- The ask — Register. Start a team. Give.
- The sign-off — White Cane. I Can.

HOW WE TALK

The mission is the message.

What makes this campaign different: we invite people to **stand for independence**— not to a night out. The Dallas Zoo is where we gather; it's never why we ask. Every message should pull toward the mission and toward action — register, start a team, give — driven by what Envision makes possible for people who are blind or have low vision across North Texas.

WE LEAD WITH

- **Envision and the mission, first** — the walk advances our work.
- **Independence** — rebuilt through employment, rehabilitation, education, outreach, and research.
- **Person-first language** — people who are blind or have low vision.
- **A clear ask** — register, start a team, or give.
- **Local relevance, made visible** — Dallas area and North Texas.
- **Real stories and lived experience** — the “I CAN” through-line.

WE STEER CLEAR OF

- × **“A free day at the zoo”** or “a fun night out” — the venue is never the pitch.
- × **Deficit or pity framing** — “the blind,” “visually impaired,” “suffering from.”
- × **Making the Zoo the headline** instead of the mission.
- × **Broad enterprise language** with no local audience, need, or impact.
- × **Year-stamped or unsourced stats** in evergreen copy.
- × **Treating the walk as entertainment** rather than a stand for independence.

When in doubt: would this move someone toward the mission, or just to the event? Always lead them to the mission.



WHY WE WALK

Imagine tomorrow morning the lights don't come back on.

How do you get to work? How do you cook dinner? How do you get dressed and walk out the door with confidence?

Losing your sight is the diagnosis Americans say they fear most — and for many North Texans, it arrives **later in life, sometimes overnight**. The independence you never had to think about becomes the thing you need most.

It isn't gone. With the right support — **employment, rehabilitation, education, outreach, and research** — independence is rebuilt. That's what Envision is here for, and that's why we walk.

150,000+

North Texans across 11 counties who are blind or have low vision

3,000+

people served by Envision Dallas every year

70%

of severe vision loss is among adults over age 80

SOURCES: ARVO · AMERICAN COMMUNITY SURVEY · CDC · ENVISION DALLAS

HIDDEN IN EVERY WHITE CANE
I CAN



GET EVERYONE INVOLVED

Who do you walk for?

Everyone walking has a reason. Share yours.

Post a photo with your “**I walk for ____**”— yourself, someone you love, or the neighbor you haven’t met yet who’s about to face this and will need a community ready to catch them.

Tag us, share your story, and help one more person find their way back to **I can.**

#I CAN Walk





01

THE DONOR

Independence is worth investing in.

LEAD WITH IMPACT

What your support makes possible.

- More than **150,000 North Texans** across 11 counties are blind or have low vision — and Envision Dallas reaches **more than 3,000 each year**. Your gift helps close that gap.
- Your support rebuilds independence — through **employment, rehabilitation, education, outreach, and research**.
- More than **8 in 10** people Envision serves live at or below the poverty line; support comes **regardless of ability to pay**.
- Every gift moves someone from “how will I?” to “**I can.**”

USE IT

Envision's community comes together this October for the White Cane Day Walk — standing for independence for people who are blind or have low vision across North Texas. Your support is what makes that independence possible. Walk with us, or give, and help more North Texans say **I can.**



02

THE CORPORATE PARTNER

Assemble your team. Walk with us.

LEAD WITH PARTNERSHIP

Visibility, and standing with the cause.

- Bring your team and show North Texas what **inclusion looks like in motion.**
- Fewer than half of working-age adults with vision loss are employed — Envision is **one of the largest employers** of people who are blind or have low vision in the U.S. and Texas.
- Stand with a community that wants to **work, contribute, and lead.**
- Your brand, **walking beside independence.**

USE IT Assemble your team and walk with us for independence. The White Cane Day Walk is where North Texas businesses stand with Envision and the people we serve — people who are blind or have low vision — visible, proud, and in it together. Let's put your team on the map.



03

THE RETURNING WALKER

You walked. Now lead the way.

THE INVITE

Come back, and bring a team.

- You showed up last year — this year, **start a team** and bring others with you.
- One captain turns a single walker into ten. **That's how this grows.**
- Every name on your team is **one more person standing for independence.**

USE IT Walked with us last year — thank you. This year, take the next step: **start a team** and bring your people. Rally friends, family, or coworkers, and help more North Texans say **I can**. Start your team at whitecanedaywalk.com.



04

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

I walk because I can.

LEAD WITH LIVED EXPERIENCE

The most powerful voice we have.

- I know what it's like to wonder how you'll **keep your independence.**
- I found my way forward — and I'm walking **so the next person can too.**
- **This is my community.** Walk with me.

USE IT I'm walking in the White Cane Day Walk because

I can — and because everyone facing vision loss deserves the same chance to say it. Walk with me on October 17.

Ready for the airwaves.

Evergreen **:30** or **FULL SPOT** and location change

Imagine the lights don't come back on. How would you get to work? Cook dinner? For thousands of North Texans, vision loss arrives suddenly — but independence isn't gone. It's rebuilt. Join Envision for the White Cane Day Walk, **[date]** at **[location]**. Start a team, walk with us, and stand for independence for people who are blind or have low vision. Register at whitecanedaywalk.com. White cane. I can.

:15 **SHORT SPOT**

Across North Texas, vision loss can happen to anyone — often overnight. But independence can be rebuilt. Join Envision for the White Cane Day Walk, **[date]** at **[location]**. Start a team and walk with us. Register at whitecanedaywalk.com.

:10 **TAG**

Walk with us for independence across North Texas. Envision's White Cane Day Walk, **[date]** at **[location]**. Start a team today at whitecanedaywalk.com.

Update only the [bracketed] details each year — everything else stays evergreen.

Ready for the screen.

Evergreen:30and:15spotsforWFAA—onlythedataandlocation change. Pair the voiceover with the b-roll notes.

:30 TV SPOT

VOICEOVER

Imagine the lights don't come back on. How would you get to work? Cook dinner? For thousands of North Texans, vision loss arrives suddenly — but independence isn't gone. It's rebuilt. Join Envision for the White Cane Day Walk, [date] at [location]. Start a team, walk with us, and stand for independence for people who are blind or have low vision. Register at whitecanedaywalk.com.

ENDCARD: **WhiteCane. I Can.** • whitecanedaywalk.com

B-ROLL

- Open close on a white cane in hand, moving.
- Everyday moments — a kitchen, a front door, getting ready with confidence.
- Walkers arriving at the Dallas Zoo; teams in matching shirts; canes along the path.
- Faces and connection — a guide and walker side by side, laughter.
- Close on the "I CAN" lockup / event end card.

:15 TV SPOT

VOICEOVER

Across North Texas, vision loss can happen to anyone — often overnight. But independence can be rebuilt. Join Envision for the White Cane Day Walk, [date] at [location]. Start a team and walk with us. Register at whitecanedaywalk.com.

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B-ROLL

- Quick cut — white-cane macro.
- Walkers in motion at the Dallas Zoo.
- A team together — energy, a cheer.
- End card with date, location, URL.

Evergreen b-roll to keep on hand: white-cane close-ups, walkers and teams in motion, candid faces and guide-and-walker moments, the Dallas Zoo setting, and a clean "I CAN" end card. Update only the [bracketed] details each year.

READY TO USE

Grab and go.

Copy, paste, post—clean lines for captions, inboxes, and feeds.

PHOTO CAPTIONS

Every white cane says it: I can. Walk with Envision

across North Texas this year. **Start a team —**

whitecanedaywalk.com

White Cane Day Walk. **Register at**

whitecanedaywalk.com

Independence looks like this. Be part of Envision's Who do you walk for? Tell us — and bring a team with you. **whitecanedaywalk.com**

We walk so more North Texans can say "I can." **Join us**

— whitecanedaywalk.com

EMAIL SUBJECT LINES

- You walked with us. This year, lead the way.
- Start your team for Envision's White Cane Day Walk
- Who will you walk for?
- Independence is worth walking for — across North Texas
- There's still time to start a team

SOCIAL KEY THEMES

Independence, rebuilt — everyday moments made possible again.

I CAN — capability over limitation, in every post.

Who do you walk for? — personal, participatory reasons.

Come back and lead — returning walkers start teams.

Community in motion — businesses, families, and the people we serve.

Right here in North Texas — Envision's work, made local and visible (lead with Envision; name Dallas area or North Texas).

PEER-TO-PEER

Share your reason.

Ready-to-send posts for team captains and fundraising pages — pick the angle that fits, drop in your link, and post.

THE ANGLE — EMPLOYMENT & INDEPENDENCE

Fewer than half of working-age adults with vision loss are employed. I'm walking for Envision — **one of the largest employers of people who are blind or have low vision in the country** — because they don't just open doors to careers, they build them. Help me reach my goal: [\[link\]](#)

THE ANGLE — LOCAL NORTH TEXAS IMPACT

There are **more than 150,000 North Texans** who are blind or have low vision. Envision Dallas provides rehabilitation, training, and assistive-technology support to thousands every year — regardless of ability to pay. I'm walking so our neighbors get the support they need: [\[link\]](#)

THE ANGLE — REBUILDING AFTER VISION LOSS

Losing your sight later in life can turn your whole world upside down, often into isolation. Envision provides the tools, training, and community people need to take back control. Every dollar I raise helps someone move from isolation to **"I can."** Walk or give with me: [\[link\]](#)

Swap [\[link\]](#) for your personal fundraising page each year — the rest stays evergreen.



FOR ANYONE, ANYWHERE

Walk with us for **independence.**

The WhiteCane DayWalk helps advance Envision's work for people who are blind or have low vision across North Texas. Join us **Saturday, October 17, at the Dallas Zoo**—register or start a team, and help more North Texans say **I can.**

OCT 17, 2026 · 5:00–7:00 PM · DALLAS ZOO · PROCEEDS SUPPORT THE ENVISION DALLAS FOUNDATION

Register & start a team — whitecanedaywalk.com

*White Cane. **I Can.***